

The blue tide is becoming a wave

送信者: EG US Daily 受信日時: 2026-09-26 00:27

【メール原文】

This week in polling: The blue tide is becoming a wave. Democrats continued their extremely strong run of polling this week. Trump's approval rating d|||||||

US Daily

[Customize Email Preferences](#)

The blue tide is becoming a wave

25 Sep 2026 11:24 EDT [Discover more on the Portal](#)

*

This week in polling: The blue tide is becoming a wave

*

Shorter truce extension will reinforce near-term US-China stability

*

Rapid spike in diesel prices in key states underpins likelihood of restrictions

*

College sports bill would create new compliance burden for media

This week in polling: The blue tide is becoming a wave. Democrats continued their extremely strong run of polling this week. Trump's approval rating dropped below 38% in Silver Bulletin's average and his net approval fell by four points, to -23%. Democrats hit a 50% vote share in the generic congressional ballot, opening their lead to 8.5 points here. That's a ten-point shift from the 2024 election. The midterms now look to be a blue wave at least as large as the 2018 race.

*

Senate polling was mostly in favor of Democrats. In North Carolina and Georgia, Roy Cooper and Senator Jon Ossoff (D-GA) held onto their (relatively) gargantuan leads; Democrats maintained modest but durable leads in Alaska, Texas, and Ohio. In Iowa, a Marist poll showed the Democrat with an eight-point lead, which—even if, as is likely, it is an overstatement—goes to show the extent of Republican weakness among rural voters at the moment.

*

Still, Democratic anxiety heading into October, even in a highly favorable year, is practically a tradition, and there was room for caution in this week's Senate polling numbers. The New York Times/Siena College poll found Susan Collins with a three-point lead in Maine, contra most recent polls of the race, and Chris Pappas in New Hampshire and Abdul El-Sayed in Michigan are well underperforming the fundamentals of their respective states. We think Democrats are slight favorites to flip the Senate (55% odds); the soft Democratic underbelly is a major reason our odds aren't higher.

*

In the House, the Democratic lead in the generic ballot means that we're getting closer to a scenario in which Democrats flip more than 20 seats, which we had previously seen as a low likelihood (with a flip of between 11 and 20 seats the most likely).

*

Looking naively, Democrats would flip about 24 House seats if a ten-point shift from 2024 is applied on a uniform nationwide basis, after accounting for redistricting. That would give Democrats 238 seats—which happens to be right in line with Silver Bulletin's current median estimate of 237; Split Ticket's is only slightly lower at 234. The larger the majority, the easier life would be for Hakeem Jeffries as speaker after the election, as it would dilute the influence of the Democratic Socialist faction in the party.

*

The sheer size of the Democratic wave at the moment—and the fact that it appears concentrated in Hispanic and young voters (see *The GOP's 2024 coalition is collapsing*, 15 September 2026)—also means that some of the Republican redistrictings of the last year could backfire, rendering them so-called “dummymanders.” That's most likely to be the case in Florida and Texas, both disproportionately young and Hispanic states, with a number of districts drawn to be Trump +10-12 on 2024 numbers. A ten-point shift away from Republicans makes those plausible Democratic pickups.

Shorter truce extension will reinforce near-term US-China stability. On 23 September, US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent announced a two-month extension of the existing trade truce (suspending US and Chinese tariffs, export controls, and port fees) with China, through 10 January 2027.

*

We expect a further extension beyond January, likely coming as part of one of two leader-level meetings planned later this year. Neither side wants the truce to expire—especially the US, which remains highly vulnerable to potential Chinese export controls on rare earth products.

*

A shorter extension is a positive for near-term stability, as it means that both sides will continue dialogue through the end of the year, and it will put pressure on both sides to deliver on near-term commitments. Washington is likely to seek greater progress on expedited Chinese approval of rare-earth export licenses for US end users, and it may also press Beijing to meet more of its commitments to purchase US agricultural exports as a condition for another extension.

*

Further underpinning this stability is the likelihood that the US's delay on arms sales to Taiwan will be extended at least through the end of the year, with the White House prioritizing US-China relations over support for Taiwan.

*

For more on our views of US-China relations coming out of the summit, please see a forthcoming note.

Rapid spike in diesel prices in key states underpins likelihood of restrictions. Diesel is up a median 89% from pre-war lows, with prices up nearly double their pre-war levels in key Senate battleground states like Ohio, Michigan, Iowa, Kansas, and Texas and driving the White House to consider restricting diesel exports (see: *US likely to restrict diesel exports*, 23 September 2026). Any relief at the pump created by export restrictions would probably be limited and create supply and price disruptions in Europe and Latin America, as the US supplies about 20% of seaborne diesel.

College sports bill would create new compliance burden for media. The Protect College Sports Act (PCSA), co-sponsored by Senator Ted Cruz (R-TX) and Senator Maria Cantwell (D-WA), has advanced through procedural votes in the Senate this week and awaits a final vote in the chamber. Beyond the gridiron, the bill has implications for broadcast media and multimedia rights (MMR) firms.

*

At its core, the bill would grant the NCAA, athletic conferences, and member institutions a sweeping antitrust protection if they comply with the revised rules covering name, image, and likeness (NIL), eligibility, and revenue-sharing set out in the bill. Supporters frame that as a long-overdue solution to address competitive balance; critics, like the NAACP, argue this provision will perpetuate a cycle of exploitation by preventing student athletes from collectivizing and limiting legal recourse to challenge NCAA rulings.

*

The bill would also allow colleges and conferences to sell their TV and streaming rights as a collective (just as the NFL and other professional sports leagues already do) if over three-quarters of Division I football schools decide to join a bargaining unit. While this doesn't shift the college football broadcasting landscape immediately, once in force, this provision will fundamentally shift bargaining power away from broadcast media to universities.

*

A further provision would effectively count NIL compensation routed through multimedia rights (MMR) deals toward a school's revenue-sharing cap; this is intended to close a widely used loophole currently utilized to compensate athletes above established caps. Notably, this creates a legally onerous certification: MMR brokers must now attest that their deals are not intended to circumvent compensation caps and that the school is not the originating source of compensation. That would be a dramatic break from the status quo and would likely put downward pressure on contract negotiations for MMR firms in NIL space.

Quote of the Day

"We cannot expect the public to have faith in our judicial system if, without clear explanation, we are consistently greenlighting harmful acts that do real damage to litigating plaintiffs without a court decision fully and fairly determining the lawfulness of that challenged conduct on the merits." - Justice Ketanji Brown Jackson speaking yesterday about the Supreme Court's use of the "emergency docket" to issue speedy rulings on interim bases, typically with no explanation of how the decision was reached; in large part due to the preponderance of rapid executive action under the Trump (and Biden) administrations, the emergency docket has expanded in recent years. While that has plenty of detractors on both sides of the judicial aisle, the court's decision last year to limit lower courts' ability to issue nationwide injunctions likely means it will find itself in the position of having to take more cases on an emergency basis.

On the Radar

18-28 September: High-Level Week at UN General Assembly

2 October: Last day Senate is in session before midterms

3 November: National midterm elections

10 November: US-China tariff truce expires

18-19 November: APEC leaders meeting in China

11 December: Government funding runs out

14-15 December: G20 summit in Florida

Clayton Allen

Practice Head, United States

+1 202.903.0027

allen@eurasiagroup.net

Noah Daponte-Smith

Senior Analyst, United States

daponte-smith@eurasiagroup.net

Kendal Walker

Senior Analyst, United States

walker@eurasiagroup.net

Jason Walter

Researcher, United States

walter@eurasiagroup.net

Pietro Guglielmi

Senior Analyst, Geoeconomics

+44 207 375 6937

guglielmi@eurasiagroup.net

Dominic Chiu

Senior Analyst, China & Northeast Asia

chiu@eurasiagroup.net

EG US Daily

unitedstates@eurasiagroup.net

© 2026 Eurasia Group. All rights reserved. This material was produced by Eurasia Group for use by the recipient. This is intended as general background research and is not intended to constitute advice on any particular commercial investment or trade matter or issue and should not be relied upon for such purposes. It is not to be made available to any person other than the recipient. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic or otherwise, without the prior consent of Eurasia Group.

X-HG-DocID cmuh3vq1xeqn507n3n4mr5hec

[Opt Out](#) | [Customize Email Preferences](#)